

controls on bottom left of the screen and the combat controls on the bottom right. On mobile, the controls feel good, even with big hands we didn't have too much trouble navigating or playing the game.

Diablo Immortal has all those other things mobile MMOs have as well, such as auto-navigation and auto-aim etc, but player interaction and skill is still necessary. Diablo Immortal has managed to capture the essence of Diablo and successfully bring it to the mobile format – long time Diablo veterans can vouch for that. A big part of the Diablo experience includes the fun of pumping those damage numbers up, grinding your way towards the gear you need, and seeing explosions of loot. Unfortunately, this is where Diablo Immortal takes a dark turn.

Diablo Immortal

You've probably seen this term floating around if you've been following Diablo Immortal. We even considered making it the title of this review, but it's been done quite a bit now. The fact that it's been done quite a bit shows you just how bad things are.

When you're new to the game, it's hard to notice the massive paywall that will soon be coming your way. However, after a certain amount of

time, you will certainly feel like you're being left far behind those who are willing to dish money out. The first and most obvious place you'll notice this is with legendary gems. Legendary gems can only be acquired in Elder Rifts, and they're powerful enough to make a significant difference in your damage output or survivability. You can have a total of six of these legendary gems equipped, each unique, and one for each piece of primary gear you have equipped. Each of these gems can hit level 10, but here's the kicker, the only way to actually level them up is by consuming other legendary gems. Then there's the fact that you need multiple of the same gem in order to rank up their star value. Yes, rank and stars are different. No clue why, but that's how it is.

The thing is, Diablo is a grindy game, and running rifts over and over again is a big part of the Diablo experience. Rifts are basically instanced dungeons where you need to kill a certain number of monsters before a timer runs out. Doing so will spawn the dungeon boss, and beating it will result in an explosion of loot. If that was all to it, we would totally be fine with it. However, the drop rates are abysmal. Or should we say, intention-

ally abysmal. In order to improve your odds of getting better loot, you need to use Crests, of which there are two kinds (actually three), Rare Crests, and Legendary Crests. You can probably already see where we're going with this. Using a Rare Crest slightly improves your odds of getting better loot, maybe even a legendary gem if you're lucky. But it also drops runes, which you can use to craft legendary gems. Keep in mind though the only way to get five star gems with runes is still chance based (so good luck with that). Now, if you use a Legendary Crest though, you're guaranteed a legendary gem drop. Read that again, guaranteed. Just to do some math here, if you're willing to spend the ₹2,200 it costs to buy 10 Legendary Crests from the shop, you would be getting in an instant what it would take a free player 6 months to get. And that's not it. Every time you clear a new dungeon, you're offered a bundle at a "discounted price". As you're leveling, you're frequently introduced to new services, which have both free and paid rewards, to further entice you to spend money on the game.

Verdict

Here's the thing, aggressive monetisation is nothing new when it comes to mobile games. Almost every single mobile MMO out there is a pay2win s**t fest. Maybe it's hypocritical of us to come down so hard on Diablo Immortal. However, there are so many instances of abusive microtransactions, so many places where the game tries to entice you to spend money, and so many currencies (22 of them!) to keep track of. It's quite a bummer, more so because the game is actually good and we can't stop playing it. We're still going to give it a shite rating. *



MOAR!

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Blizzard
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PLATFORMS

Android, iOS,
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PRICE

Free (Iol)